it true that increased national security erodes freedom of the press. These two things can and must coexist peacefully, with each supporting the other. The subtext of this statement is that a journalist must not shirk his or her personal national responsibility when a person in an official position has made a transgression!

It is possible—but not necessary—to discuss the internet revolution as part of the debate on national security and the media. I have chosen to do this for two reasons. The first is the Snowden affair, which touches the heart of the dilemma over what is permitted and what is forbidden in the disclosure of state secrets. The second is the initiation of revolutions through the medium of the internet (as was the case in some of the countries that experienced the so-called “Arab Spring”), which also touches upon the issue of national resilience.

The internet is the technology that has produced the greatest change in human society in recent decades. More than any other technology, it has transformed the world into a completely transparent global village where an unlimited amount of information flows from any point on earth to another in real time. The internet enables anyone to become a media superstar if he or she is able to release even a scrap of information that someone else wants to conceal or prevent from being publicized.

This ability has produced what is commonly referred to as “breaking the fear barrier.” When you can communicate with anyone and send them a text or a photograph in real time, ahead of all the professional media networks, turning any type of censorship into a joke, you have nothing to be afraid of. And as the internet fills up with more and more users, even the slightest bit of fear that remains inside you disappears.

Today, the internet is both a battleground and a weapon that is at the disposal of every individual, organization, or country, with each being free to define the enemy and fight it with the means and methods it deems necessary. There are still no “laws of war” for this battlefield or for the doctrines of warfare practiced on it.

It is said that about 90 percent of the intelligence needed by any intelligence body comes from open sources. These days, the internet is the largest source of open intelligence, and from it one can derive strategic intelligence, tactical intelligence, and even intelligence for specific operations, down to a terrorist’s or other wanted person’s flight details, photograph, passport number, and rental car at his destination.